

W H A L E C L A S S

Circle Time Guide

Everything you need, one page per day

My House

Week 12

Week of Nov 9–13

13 minutes a day

ages 2.5–6

English learners





Week 12 · Week Overview

My House
Print · laminate · ring-bind · hold this all week

5 words they'll own by Friday →

house

door

key

kitchen

bed

Little's (2.5–3)

One word + a gesture is a win: **"House!"** (both hands make a roof over your head), **"Door!"** (push an imaginary door open — knock, knock), **"Bed!"** (hands to the cheek, head tips over).

Bigs (4–6)

Sentence frames: **"This is my house."**

"I sleep in my bedroom."

"We cook in the kitchen."

"The key opens the door."

The week at a glance

MON	A House With Rooms	a little wooden doll's house with the roof lifted off in the Magic Box
TUE	Knock, Knock!	a real brass door handle and a doorbell that actually rings in the Magic Box; the classroom do...
WED	Click! The Key	a heavy bunch of keys and three padlocks in the Magic Box
THU	In the Kitchen	a wooden spoon, a bowl and a small pot in the Magic Box; a placemat with the plate, bowl, spoo...
FRI	Goodnight, House! + Big Review	a pillow and a folded blanket in the Magic Box, plus every prop from the week back inside it (...)

2 MIN

Magic Box hook

4 MIN

Teach the words

3 MIN

Song · today's verse

3 MIN

Game · move it

1 MIN

Whisper-shout close

Weekly rituals — use these every single day

Attention grabber: Teacher: **"One, two, three — eyes on me!"** · Kids: **"One, two — eyes on you!"**

The Magic Box: any box with a lid. Chant it, shake it, sniff it, peek dramatically — the day's key prop lives inside.

The two-tier rule: never make a little produce a sentence, and never let a big get away with one word.

Whisper → shout close: calms them down, then releases them — every single closing.

Teacher-fails-on-purpose: once a day, get it wrong and let them correct you — the correction shout is the loudest language of the day.

One song a week: same chorus at every circle, one new verse each morning, the whole song on Friday.

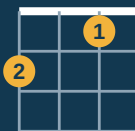
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G C E A

C

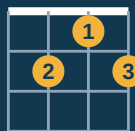
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G C E A

F

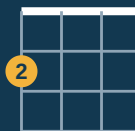
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G C E A

G7

0 0 0



G C E A

Am

Uke quick-ref

Strum: Down · Down · Down-Up ("this — is — my house"). Can't manage it yet? Four slow downs per bar works fine — the kids only hear the fun.

The song needs only **C · F · G7 · Am**.

MONDAY

A House With Rooms

Today's words: **house**

Grab: a little **wooden doll's house with the roof lifted off** in the Magic Box — you can see every room at once; a basket of blocks for the middle of the circle; a small doll to walk round the rooms; the home character card.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

The box is **big** today, and heavy. Carry it in with two hands and put it down as if it might break. Whole class chants:

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

Tip it a little — one soft wooden knock inside. Peek in, and stare for a long moment.

TEACHER (*whisper*) "There is a whole **HOUSE** in this box." (*lift the doll's house out slowly, roof off, and turn it round so everyone sees inside*)

Both hands over your head to make a roof. **"House!"**

4 MIN TEACH · HOUSE

Put the house in the middle where every child can see down into it. Point into each room, one at a time, and say what happens there.

A **roof** on the top... (*both hands make a roof over your head*)

A **floor** down below. (*pat the floor twice*)

A **door** to go in... (*push an imaginary door open*)

That's my **HOUSE** — in you go! (*sweep both arms in*)

Now the little doll walks the rooms. **Kitchen** — we cook. **Bedroom** — we sleep. **Bathroom** — we wash. **Living room** — we sit together. Every child gets to walk the doll into one room and the class names it with you.

LITTLES say the one word and make the roof: **"House!"** **BIGS** take the full frame: **"This is my house."**

Teacher fails: put the little **bed in the kitchen** and the **pot in the bathroom**, stand back and look extremely pleased with yourself. Wait. They will move it all back for you, loudly.

Chinese moment: home is the character of the week, and one of the loveliest in the language — a roof with a pig underneath. A house was only a house once there was an animal in it. Draw the roof. Draw the pig. Then draw **home**. Lay the card on the mat — one character a day, no drilling.

3 MIN GAME · BUILD MY HOUSE

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" The basket of blocks comes to the middle and everybody sits round the empty floor.

TEACHER "One block each. What room shall we build first?"

Round the circle, one child at a time, one block each. As each part appears you name it and the class says it back: walls, **"Door!"**, **"Window!"**, and last of all the **roof** — everybody makes the roof over their heads as the last block goes on.

BIGS get a room each: **"This is the kitchen."** **LITTLES** just place their block and name it: **"House!"**

If it falls over — and it will — cheer, and build it again. A house that falls down twice is more fun than a house that stands, and they get twice the language out of it.

1 MIN CLOSE

Roof hands over the head, then fling both arms wide on the shout. Whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "Door... key... **KITCHEN!** This is **MY HOUSE!**" (*roof hands, then arms wide on the last word*)

Got 3 spare minutes? *A House Is a House for Me* (Mary Ann Hoberman) — a hill is a house for an ant, a hive is a house for a bee. By page four they will be shouting the next one at you.

♪ **TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · THIS IS MY HOUSE** chorus → Monday's verse → chorus

CHORUS

C This is my **F** house, my house, my **C** house, (*hands make a roof*)

F Big enough for **C** me and a little **G7** mouse! **C** (*arms wide, then a tiny pinch*)

C A door to **F** open, a bed to **Am** keep, (*push open, then hands to the cheek*)

F A kitchen to **C** eat and a **G7** room to **C** sleep! (*eat, then snore*)

MONDAY · HOUSE

C A roof on the top and a floor below, (*roof hands, then pat the floor*)

G7 That's my house — **C** in you go! (*sweep both arms in*)

The one song of the week — same chorus at every circle, one new verse each morning. Chords and the full sheet are on the Song tab. The chorus is a finger-play: they will do the actions long before they sing the words.

TUESDAY

Knock, Knock!

Today's words: **door** (*house comes back every day*)

Grab: a real brass **door handle** and a **doorbell that actually rings** in the Magic Box; the classroom door itself; the door character card. It is just past **Winter Begins** — cold outside, so the door gets closed properly behind us today.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

The box comes out ordinary. Chant it as always — then, halfway through, press the doorbell that is hiding inside it.

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

DING... DONG! Stop dead. Look at the door of the classroom. Look at the box. Look at the door again.

TEACHER "Somebody is at the **door**... but the door is over THERE!" (*ring it once more, then lift out the bell and the brass handle*)

Push an imaginary door open, knock twice on the air. "**Door!**"

4 MIN TEACH · DOOR

Take the whole circle to the real classroom door and stand round it. Open. Closed. Open. Closed.

Knock, knock, knock! (*three knocks on the real door*)

Open! (*pull it wide, arms open*)

Closed. (*shut it gently, both hands, no bang*)

Come in, come in! (*wave everybody through*)

Then the brass handle goes round the circle: hold it, turn it, feel how cold and heavy it is. **LITTLES** say the one word: "**Door!**"

BIGS take the frame: "**The door is open.**" / "**Please close the door.**"

Teacher fails: knock politely on the **window**, then wait, puzzled, and knock again harder. "Nobody is answering!" Let them march you to the door.

Chinese moment: **door** joins home on the mat — two doors of a gate, drawn in two strokes. We have just had **Winter Begins**: It is cold — go home and close the door — it is cold now, so we come home and we **close the door**. From today, every child closes the door behind them properly, with two hands and no bang.

3 MIN GAME · KNOCK KNOCK, WHO'S THERE?

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" One child goes quietly outside the classroom door and closes it. Everyone else sits still.

OUTSIDE (*three knocks*) "Knock, knock!"

EVERYONE "Who's there?"

The child outside answers in a silly voice — a squeak, a growl, a whisper — and the class guesses **who** it is before the door opens. Then the door opens and everybody shouts the name.

BIGS may add a whole line: "**It's me — open the door!**" **LITTLES** just knock and let the class do the rest.

Every child gets a turn; it takes about fifteen seconds each. Keep the door only half-latched so a two-year-old can open it alone — the opening is the best part and they must be the one who does it.

1 MIN CLOSE

Three knocks on the floor, then the shout. Whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "Door... key... KITCHEN! This is MY HOUSE!" (*knock, knock, knock — then arms wide*)

Got 3 spare minutes? *The Doorbell Rang* (Pat Hutchins) — the doorbell goes again, and again, and again. Ring the real doorbell on every page and let them count who has arrived.

» TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · THIS IS MY HOUSE chorus → Tuesday's verse → chorus

CHORUS

C This is my **F** house, my house, my **C** house, (*hands make a roof*)

F Big enough for **C** me and a little **G7** mouse! **C** (*arms wide, then a tiny pinch*)

C A door to **F** open, a bed to **Am** keep, (*push open, then hands to the cheek*)

F A kitchen to **C** eat and a **G7** room to **C** sleep! (*eat, then snore*)

TUESDAY · DOOR

C Knock, knock, knock — who's at the door? (*three knocks on the floor, on the beat*)

G7 Come in, come in — **C** there's room for more! (*both arms wave everyone in*)

Do the three knocks on the wooden floor, all together, on the beat. Twenty children knocking in time is the loudest and most satisfying moment of the week.

WEDNESDAY

Click! The Key

Today's words: **key** (*house · door come back*)

Grab: a heavy **bunch of keys** and **three padlocks** in the Magic Box — only one key opens each one; a tray to work on; a wooden spoon (for the teacher fail!); the window character card.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

This box **rattles harder than any box all year**. Do not tell them what it is. Chant, then shake it once, enormously.

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

JANGLE! Freeze. Shake it again, softly, right beside one child's ear. Then round the whole circle, one shake each.

TEACHER "Something in here is made of **metal**... and there are LOTS of them." (*lift out the bunch of keys and let them hang and swing*)

Turn an imaginary key in the air — *click*. **"Key!"**

4 MIN TEACH · KEY

One padlock in the middle of the mat, closed. Hold it up. Pull at it. It will not open.

Locked. (*tug the padlock, both hands, it holds*)

A little **key**... (*hold one key up high so it catches the light*)

Turn it — **click!** (*turn it slowly, everyone leans in*)

Open! (*the shackle springs, hold it up in triumph*)

Then the language, in the same order every time: **locked** → **key** → **turn** → **click** → **open**. **LITTLES** say the one word and turn their hand: **"Key!"** **BIGS** take the frame: **"The key opens the door."**

Now hand the padlock and the right key to a child and let them do it in front of everybody. Nobody helps. The **click** is worth waiting twenty seconds for.

Teacher fails: try to unlock the padlock with the **wooden spoon**. Push. Twist. Try the other end. Then get thoroughly cross **with the padlock** — "What is **WRONG** with you today?" — and wait for twenty children to put a key in your hand.

Chinese moment: **window** joins home and door on the mat. The door lets *you* in; the window lets the *light* in. Stand at the classroom window and say it once, looking out.

3 MIN GAME · FIND THE KEY THAT FITS

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" Three padlocks on the tray, all locked, and a pile of keys beside them.

TEACHER "One key at a time. Ready? Try it..."

One child, one padlock, one key at a time — and the **whole circle counts the tries out loud**: "One... two... three..." On the click, everybody cheers.

LITTLES hand the keys over and shout **"Key!"** with each try. **BIGS** report back: **"This key opens this lock."**

Control of error is the lock itself — nobody has to say "wrong", the key simply does not turn. Say nothing when it fails; the material has already spoken, and the child just tries the next one.

1 MIN CLOSE

Everybody turns a key in the air on the word "key". Whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "Door... key... **KITCHEN!** This is **MY HOUSE!**" (*one enormous turn of the wrist on "key"*)

Got 3 spare minutes? Any lift-the-flap house book — *Where's Spot?* (Eric Hill) works perfectly: every flap is a door, and every door has something behind it.

› **TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · THIS IS MY HOUSE** chorus → Wednesday's verse → chorus

CHORUS

C This is my **F** house, my house, my **C** house, (*hands make a roof*)

F Big enough for **C** me and a little **G7** mouse! **C** (*arms wide, then a tiny pinch*)

C A door to **F** open, a bed to **Am** keep, (*push open, then hands to the cheek*)

F A kitchen to **C** eat and a **G7** room to **C** sleep! (*eat, then snore*)

WEDNESDAY · KEY

Am A little key goes **click, click, click**, (*three tiny turns of the wrist*)

G7 Turn it round — **C** open, quick! (*one big turn, both hands fly open*)

Sing the three "clicks" as three tiny, quiet notes and the last line loud. The **Am** makes it sound like a secret, which is exactly what a key is to a four-year-old.

THURSDAY

In the Kitchen

Today's words: **kitchen** (*house · door · key come back*)

Grab: a **wooden spoon, a bowl and a small pot** in the Magic Box; a placemat with the plate, bowl, spoon and cup drawn on it as outlines (print pack, tray 3) and the four real things in a basket; the kitchen character card.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

Today the box smells faintly of dinner and knocks like wood. Chant, then tap the box twice from inside with the spoon.

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

Tick. Tick. Sniff at the lid. Close your eyes and stir the air with one hand, slowly.

TEACHER "Mmm... I think somebody is **cooking** in there." (*lift out the pot, then the bowl, then the wooden spoon — and stir*)

Stir a big pot in the air. "**Kitchen!**"

4 MIN TEACH · KITCHEN

The pot goes in the middle. Everything that belongs in a kitchen comes out of it, one thing at a time, named and passed round.

Pot — we cook in it. (*hold it up with both hands*)

Spoon — we stir with it. (*big slow stir*)

Bowl — we eat from it. (*cup it and pretend to eat*)

Cup — we drink from it! (*drink, then a satisfied "Ahh"*)

Then the whole class cooks together: everybody stirs, everybody blows on the spoon, everybody tastes and says whether it needs more. **LITTLES** say the one word: "**Kitchen!**" **BIGS** take the frame: "**We cook in the kitchen.**"

Teacher fails: try to stir the pot with **yesterday's padlock key**, then try to eat the soup with the **door handle**. Look completely satisfied. Wait for the corrections — and they will hand you the right thing, which is the whole lesson.

Chinese moment: **kitchen** goes down beside home, door and window. Ask who cooks at home — mum? dad? grandma? — and let three children answer in Chinese and then again in English: "**We cook in the kitchen.**"

3 MIN GAME · SET THE TABLE

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" The placemat goes at one end of the room with its four outlines showing; the basket of real things sits with you at the other.

TEACHER "Take ONE thing. Walk — don't run — and put it where it belongs."

One child, one object, one careful walk: plate, bowl, spoon, cup. They lay it **on its own outline** and walk back. "**Plate!**" **BIGS** "**The spoon goes here.**"

When the mat is full, everybody claps, you clear it, and the next four go. Do it three or four times round so every child carries something.

Control of error is the outline — the shape either matches or it doesn't, and the child sees it before you do. Carrying one real, slightly heavy object slowly across a room is practical life, not a game about words — and that is why the language sticks to it.

1 MIN CLOSE

Everybody stirs a big pot on the word "kitchen". Whisper → normal → shout:

EVERYONE "Door... key... KITCHEN! This is MY HOUSE!" (*one huge stir on KITCHEN*)

Got 3 spare minutes? *Pancakes, Pancakes!* (Eric Carle) — a whole book of kitchen words, and by the end they are stirring with you.

♪ TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · THIS IS MY HOUSE chorus → Thursday's verse → chorus

CHORUS

C This is my **F** house, my house, my **C** house, (*hands make a roof*)

F Big enough for **C** me and a little **G7** mouse! **C** (*arms wide, then a tiny pinch*)

C A door to **F** open, a bed to **Am** keep, (*push open, then hands to the cheek*)

F A kitchen to **C** eat and a **G7** room to **C** sleep! (*eat, then snore*)

THURSDAY · KITCHEN

C Stir the pot and lay the plate, (*big stir, then lay the places*)

G7 Dinner's ready — **C** don't be late! (*both hands beckon*)

Sing it once sitting and once standing round an imaginary table. The "don't be late!" line gets shouted; let it.

FRIDAY

Goodnight, House! + Big Review

Today's words: **house · door · key · kitchen · bed** — the whole week

Grab: a **pillow** and a **folded blanket** in the Magic Box, plus every prop from the week back inside it (doll's house, door handle, doorbell, keys and padlocks, pot and spoon); a floor plan chalked on the mat — four big rooms; the awards (print pack page 17); the bed character card.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

The box comes out **fat**, soft on the top and rattling underneath. Chant it, then press down on the lid — it squashes.

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

TEACHER "Today the box is FULL... and something in here is **soft**." (pull out the pillow, hug it, and yawn enormously)

Hands to the cheek, head tipped over. "**Bed!**"

Then everything else comes out one at a time and held up in silence — they will supply the word before you can. Doll's house → "**House!**" Handle → "**Door!**" Keys → "**Key!**" Pot → "**Kitchen!**"

4 MIN TEACH · BED, THEN THE WHOLE WEEK

The pillow and the blanket go in the middle. Lie down beside them, right there on the mat, and do it properly.

Pillow — soft. (cheek down on it, eyes closed)

Blanket — warm. (pull it up to your chin)

Lights off... (click an imaginary switch)

Goodnight, house! (one enormous snore — then sit bolt upright)

LITTLES say the one word and tip their head: "**Bed!**" **BIGS** "**I sleep in my bedroom.**"

Then everybody stands and we tell the whole week with our bodies, twice — slow, then fast:

A roof — my **house!** (roof hands over the head)

Knock knock — the **door!** (three knocks in the air)

Click — the **key!** (turn the wrist)

Stir — the **kitchen!** (big stir)

Shh — my **BED!** (hands to the cheek, head over, everybody snores)

Teacher fails: put the **pillow in the pot** and try to stir it, then lie down with your head on the **padlock**. Sigh happily. Let them rescue you twice.

Chinese moment: **bed** completes the row — home · door · window · kitchen · bed. Point along the line and let them tell you which one you are standing on. Sing "A Little Home" if they know it.

3 MIN GAME · WHICH ROOM?

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" Four big rooms are chalked on the mat — **kitchen, bedroom, bathroom, living room** — and the week's props are in a heap in the middle.

TEACHER "Take one thing. Which room does it live in? — GO!"

Each child grabs one object and runs it to the right room, then says it: "**Kitchen!**" **BIGS** owe you the sentence: "**The pot goes in the kitchen.**"

Twelve objects, everybody goes twice, and the last round is the whole class at once — total, delighted chaos, and then we tidy it together.

Put one thing in that could go in two rooms — the cup. Watch them argue. Both answers are right; say so out loud, and say **why** each one is right.

1 MIN CLOSE + AWARDS

Every child gets a "You are a STAR!" award to take home with their house drawing. Then, standing, with all five gestures:

EVERYONE "House... door... key... kitchen... BED! This is MY HOUSE!" (roof · knock · turn · stir · head on hands, then arms wide)

Got 3 spare minutes? *Goodnight Moon* (Margaret Wise Brown) — goodnight to every single thing in the room. Let them say goodnight to the classroom, object by object, as they leave.

♪ **TODAY'S SONG MOMENT · THIS IS MY HOUSE** Friday's verse, then the WHOLE song, top to bottom

CHORUS

C This is my **F** house, my house, my **C** house, (hands make a roof)

F Big enough for **C** me and a little **G7** mouse! **C** (arms wide, then a tiny pinch)

C A door to **F** open, a bed to **Am** keep, (push open, then hands to the cheek)

F A kitchen to **C** eat and a **G7** room to **C** sleep! (eat, then snore)

FRIDAY · BED

C Pillow soft and blanket tight, (cheek on hands, pull the blanket up)

G7 Off go the lights — **C** goodnight, goodnight! (click the switch, everybody snores)

The finale: chorus → Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday, Friday → chorus, top to bottom, with the **pillow passed round the circle** — whoever is holding it does the actions biggest. Everyone snores on the last chord. They learned it one verse a morning without noticing, and this run-through is the review of the whole week.

★ This Is My House

Week 12 theme song
C (0003) · F (2010) · G7 (0212) · Am (2000)

The one song of the week — sung at every circle. Same chorus daily, one new verse each morning, full song on Friday.

CHORUS — SING IT EVERY SINGLE DAY

- C** This is my **F** house, my house, my **C** house, *(hands make a roof)*
F Big enough for **C** me and a little **G7** mouse! **C** *(arms wide, then a tiny pinch)*
C A door to **F** open, a bed to **Am** keep, *(push open, then hands to the cheek)*
F A kitchen to **C** eat and a **G7** room to **C** sleep! *(eat, then snore)*

MONDAY · HOUSE

- C** A roof on the top and a floor below, *(roof hands, then pat the floor)*
G7 That's my house — **C** in you go! *(sweep both arms in)*

TUESDAY · DOOR

- C** Knock, knock, knock — who's at the door? *(three knocks on the floor, on the beat)*
G7 Come in, come in — **C** there's room for more! *(both arms wave everyone in)*

WEDNESDAY · KEY

- Am** A little key goes click, click, click, *(three tiny turns of the wrist)*
G7 Turn it round — **C** open, quick! *(one big turn, both hands fly open)*

THURSDAY · KITCHEN

- C** Stir the pot and lay the plate, *(big stir, then lay the places)*
G7 Dinner's ready — **C** don't be late! *(both hands beckon)*

FRIDAY · BED

- C** Pillow soft and blanket tight, *(cheek on hands, pull the blanket up)*
G7 Off go the lights — **C** goodnight, goodnight! *(click the switch, everybody snores)*

Strum: Down · Down · Down-Up (“this — is — my house”).

Can't manage it yet? Four slow downs per bar works fine — the kids only hear the fun.

Practice this loop for five minutes tonight: **C** (4 strums) → **F** (4 strums) → **C** → **G7** → **C**. Add **Am** last: it is one finger on the same string as F, so slide from Am to F and back until it stops feeling like a change. That's the entire song — and four of the five verses are only C and G7. If your fingers get stuck, put the uke down and do the finger-play instead: the class will not notice, and the actions carry the meaning either way.